



THE CADRES ARE ANGRY OVER THE WAY THE LEADERSHIP DEALT WITH VARADARAJAN

Even the Comrades who swooned along with Karat in the Central Committee, are now questioning the decision of micro-managing personal lives and insist that comrades through history were susceptible to flash and charm and were romantics in disguise. His mysterious identity and swarthy good looks had made Che Guevara a sex symbol, heroic victim and the ultimate poster boy of revolutionary chic. Though Lenin's life was overwhelmingly dominated by politics, he continued a love affair with the French-born revolutionary, Inessa Armand.

Closer home, some of the tallest leaders in Karat's native Kerala are known to have openly mixed revolution with rest and recreation and in at least one case, the party is known to have adopted a child that a senior party member is said to have fathered out of wedlock. Varadarajan wasn't that lucky. Problems first rose years ago when his wife suspected him of having a relationship with Yamuna, their maidservant. The maid was sent back to her native village but

BY PRONOUNCING VARADARAJAN GUILTY WITHOUT even giving him a hearing, the commissars of AKG Bhavan have just moved a step closer to Stalindom.

marital issues seemed to be simmering. Despite the Central Committee being informed in writing that one of those levelling sexual harassment charges against Varadarajan was a "woman of low repute", the committee never found it fit to discuss the long letter that Varadarajan had penned before walking out of his house. Instead, Karat created a credibility gap by pushing the wishes of a particular faction within the state unit. "We never bothered to question the proposal of the Politburo thinking that the complaint was thoroughly examined. Now we feel sad that we were part of a decision that pushed an important Comrade to death," says a senior Central Committee member. Another member adds: "There are many top leaders who have marital problems.

Even now, there are top members in the Central Committee who have got divorced to marry again. The party has never taken action against any of them." But the mechanical raising of hands by the Central Committee members who gathered at Alimuddin Street to declare Varadarajan guilty is a sad commentary on the centralised democracy system in the party, where decisions are forced through, sometime with fatal results.

As the CPI(M) draws the thick red lines, comrades in AKG Bhavan probably need to be reminded about G. Pyatakov, a victim of Joseph Stalin's Great Purge. During his trial he pleaded: "In a few hours you will pass your sentence. And here I stand before you in filth, crushed by my own crimes, bereft of everything through my own fault, a man who has lost his party, who has no friends, who has lost his family, who has lost his very self." And Varadarajan's last plea before he took his own life was no different. The resident commissar of AKG Bhavan has just moved one step closer to Stalindom. ■

SOME OF THE PARTY'S TALLEST LEADERS IN Karat's home state, Kerala, are known to have mixed revolution with a bit of rest and recreation.